

AGROSOLAR TECHNOPRENEURSHIP AND INNOVATION CENTRE (ASTIC)



PROJECT PARTNERS AND THEIR ROLES

UNIUYO

Lead institution with expertise in industrial chemistry, Agriculture overseeing project execution and student training initiatives.

MMU

Responsible for governance and evaluation, ensuring sustainability and quality in project execution and outcomes.



Benue State Polytechnic

Offers environmental microbiology expertise, linking project outputs with relevant government policies and training support.

TISG Ltd

Technical lead for solar prototype design and installation, providing industry connections and sustainability insights.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The AgroSolar Technopreneurship and Innovation Centre (ASTIC) aims to integrate solar energy into agricultural practices, enhancing productivity and sustainability. By fostering innovation and education, this initiative will develop essential skills for students in green technology and agro-processing.



PROJECT OBJECTIVES

Develop Prototype

Create and validate a solar-powered agro-processing prototype that meets industry standards for sustainability.

Co-design Toolkit

Develop a modular training toolkit integrating EDI principles within the UNIUYO curriculum for student engagement.

Build Capacity

Enhance student skills in green enterprise, circular economy, and technopreneurship for future employment opportunities.

Foster Partnerships

Strengthen collaborations between UK and Nigerian institutions to promote shared knowledge and technical expertise.

Promote Inclusion

Ensure active participation of women and individuals with disabilities in training and project activities.

Disseminate Results

Share project findings through policy briefs and academic publications to influence sustainable practices in agriculture.

OUTPUTS

- ❑ Prototype system and training toolkit
 - ❑ Student-led business models and pitches
 - ❑ Workshops and showcase event
 - ❑ Policy brief, publications, and knowledge repository
 - ❑ Formal partnership agreements
 - ❑ Improved student innovation and employability
 - ❑ Institutionalisation of innovation tools
 - ❑ Sustained multi-stakeholder partnerships
 - ❑ Scalable model for green enterprise education
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BENEFITS

- ❑ The project will build long-term, multi-stakeholder partnerships across academia, industry, and the public sector, improving the alignment of higher education outputs with real-world needs.
- ❑ The UK-Nigeria alliance will provide University of Uyo with access to cutting-edge research, mentorship models, and entrepreneurship support structures from Manchester Metropolitan University. Simultaneously, Nigerian institutions will contribute local insights

IMPACT & SDGS

- ❑ SDG 2: Reduce food loss via solar-powered systems
 - ❑ SDG 7: Expand clean energy access in agriculture
 - ❑ SDG 12: Promote circular economy and resource efficiency
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IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- ❑ Capacity building and prototype development
 - ❑ Workshops, mentoring, and student innovation challenges
 - ❑ Stakeholder engagement and dissemination
 - ❑ Monitoring and evaluation
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SUSTAINABILITY & SCALABILITY

- ❑ Curriculum integration and institutional ownership
 - ❑ Ongoing UK–Nigeria collaboration
 - ❑ Replication across Sub-Saharan Africa (SSA) institutions
 - ❑ Industry and policy engagement
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